

## 8. Vinegar

Adding vinegar to water is similar to adding citrus. You will get sour water that has vitamin C. When I was a kid I liked adding apple cider vinegar to water before drinking it.

Of course any of these things could also be added to soda water if you want to make your own lightly flavored soda. The possibilities are really endless since you can mix and match the ingredients any way you want. — **Xin Lu**



# 10 Ways to Create a Gourmet Kitchen on a Shoestring

Having a well-stocked, stylish gourmet kitchen does not have to cost a mint. In fact, implementing just a few of the following ideas can save you thousands of dollars, and make

your kitchen look fantastic. Here are 10 ways to create a gourmet kitchen but still stay on budget.

## 1. Display your cooking ingredients

These have a great deal of color, texture, and aroma, which makes for loads of visual drama in the kitchen decor department. A large jar of tri-color peppercorns with a nice grinder is an affordable choice. Garlic ropes, chili pepper garlands, and large bottles of infused oils and specialty vinegars are other consumable decor items that make a nice visual statement. Use space like the soffit over your cupboards. A great way to work this in with style is with clear glass containers. Extra large glass canisters available at restaurant supply and discount department stores are great for holding things you might normally put in white food storage buckets. Since the soffit is more of a decorative area, giant containers of things like dried chili peppers, chana dal, and turtle beans can serve both form and function in this case.

## 2. DIY kitchen islands

There are tons of fun, affordable ways to make your own island and add to the functionality and style